

**July: Amazon.com Is Born**

Jeff Bezos launched “Earth’s largest bookstore”—Amazon.com. Though Bezos founded the online bookstore in 1994, the site went online for the first time in 1995. It was initially named cadabra.com.

**August: VSNL Starts**

VSNL began offering Internet services to the general public in India. VSNL’s Gateway Internet Access Service was first available in the four metros—(then) Bombay, Delhi, Calcutta, and Madras. The first plans on offer were a 9.6 kbps dialup connection, and 9.6, 64, and 128 kbps leased line connections. VSNL only had 100 dial-in lines to start with, and it was connected to its international partner MCI with a 128 kbps to 2 Mbps link.

**September: NVIDIA’s First Card Released**

The NV1, NVIDIA’s first graphics card, was released. Besides a graphics core, it also had audio playback capability and a Sega console connector. This allowed Sega games to be played on PCs. Shortly after it was released, Microsoft announced the development of DirectX which used a different graphics rendering methodology. This quickly made the NV1 untouchable!

**September: DirectX Launched**

Microsoft released DirectX 1.0. It was created to compete with OpenGL, which already was in use. DirectX includes APIs like Direct3D, responsible for all graphics instructions, and DirectSound, responsible for audio instructions.

**September: RedHat Created**

Red Hat Software was created by merging Bob Young’s ACC Corporation (started in 1993), which was involved in selling Linux-related books and accessories; and Mark Ewing’s Linux distribution business (started in 1994), which was selling a Linux distro called Red Hat Linux. Red Hat Linux version 2, the first one released post-merger, introduced an easy way of managing installation and removal of applications from the Linux system, called RPM (RPM Package Management).